Josh McVey

Software Engineer · Lead SDET & Test Architect · Systems Integration

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SUMMARY

Hands-on software engineer, Lead SDET, and Test Architect with 15+ years in software. I connect product purpose, primary users, and business objectives to engineering decisions, shared acceptance criteria, and delivery. I work across product and engineering to clarify stakeholder needs and tradeoffs, then carry that context through design, automated verification, release, and production. At Opentrons, I build cloud applications, own OAuth/OIDC authentication, develop Python/TypeScript robot-interaction clients, and own release pipelines for two robot operating systems and the application suite. Lawrence, Kansas; open to remote roles with approximately 15–40% travel.

CORE SKILLS

Product & Stakeholders	User workflows, business and software objectives, requirements clarification, stakeholder alignment, acceptance criteria, engineering tradeoffs, delivery outcomes
Software & Integration	Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C#, Groovy; REST, GraphQL, OAuth/OIDC, PostgreSQL, Node; full-stack applications and robot-interaction clients
Platform & Delivery	AWS ECS, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes / OpenShift, Helm, Datadog; release orchestration and developer experience
Quality & Reliability	Lead SDET, test architecture, shift-left testing, testability, test framework design, API testing, pytest, Playwright/Puppeteer, Selenium, BDD/TDD, UAT automation, performance testing
AI & Technical Practice	AI evaluations, model and API upgrades, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), Amazon Bedrock, direct model APIs, agentic release tooling; code review and mentoring

EXPERIENCE

Opentrons Labworks

Feb 2024 – Present

Lead Software Engineer & Build & Release Manager

Remote (HQ: Long Island City, NY)

- Own release pipelines for two robot operating systems and the application suite; built agentic tooling that enables colleagues with less technical experience to conduct releases.
- Maintain Opentrons AI v1 and support the team with evaluations, model and API upgrades, and RAG improvements; provide infrastructure and application framework using AWS ECS, Amazon Bedrock, and direct model API calls.
- Own OAuth/OIDC authentication across web products; developed TypeScript/Python robot-interaction clients and reusable AI-assisted development workflows.
- Added build and release responsibilities in February 2024 while continuing the software development and SDET work below.

Opentrons Labworks
Jun 2021 – Present

Senior Developer & SDET
Remote (HQ: Long Island City, NY)

- Architect, build, and operate Protocol Library (library.opentrons.com) and Opentrons Accounts, from application design through implementation.
- Built GitHub Actions/AWS CI/CD and test frameworks that shortened robot software release cycles.
- Implemented Datadog monitoring and proactive incident detection across cloud services.
- Architect test automation across on-robot systems, desktop applications, and HTTP APIs; mentor engineers in testing.

TEKsystems
Aug 2019 – Jun 2021

Test Automation Architect — Continuous Testing Practice
Remote

- Practice architect for continuous testing across client engagements.
- Led pytest feature automation for a gaming-engine team of 10 (Python) and browser UAT in Azure DevOps for an energy-sector website team of 5 (JavaScript/TypeScript).

Rackspace
Nov 2016 – Aug 2019

Software Developer, Test III (Lead SDET)
Remote

- Lead SDET on a dedicated-device web portal spanning customer-facing applications, ETL pipelines, and APIs; wrote and reviewed code across teams.
- Automation and services in Python (pytest, requests, Selenium), Java (TestNG, RestAssured), TypeScript (Ava, Puppeteer), and Groovy (Grails, Spock).
- Delivery stack: Jenkins, OpenShift/Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, GraphQL, StreamSets, Elasticsearch.

Xpanxion
2009–2012; 2013–2016

Test Architect · Lead Automation Engineer · Automation Test Lead / Manager
Remote / Kearney, NE

- Hands-on QA strategy and automation consulting on long-term client engagements.
- Built frameworks for web, APIs, ETL, mobile, and desktop; BDD/TDD with Cucumber-JVM, JUnit, TestNG, NUnit, and MSTest.
- Performance testing with LoadRunner and JMeter; mentored engineers on automation and testing.

Earlier roles
2003 – 2013

Epiq Systems · Standard Beverage · Target · Independent IT
Kansas / Nebraska

- Epiq Systems (2012–2013): C# unit-test and coded-UI automation for web and desktop applications.
- Standard Beverage (2009): ASP.NET/VB.NET applications, operations dashboards, and DB2 / SQL Server database design.
- Earlier work: operations at Target; nonprofit websites, networks, databases, AV implementation, and end-user training.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Kansas State University
1996 – 2003

B.S., Physical Sciences

- ISTQB Certified Tester, Foundation Level (CTFL)